

KATHERINE HAJER

Product designer, HCI researcher, Senior BSA, technical writer

Portfolio: <https://khajer-uxui.github.io/public/index.html>

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ABOUT

Product Architect and UX Designer with 15+ years of experience bridging advanced business systems analysis, accessibility, and human-centred design across fintech, payments, and enterprise software. I have a proven record of reverse-engineering complex legacy pipelines, mitigating technical debt, and building high-impact tools, from AI orchestration to secure financial infrastructure, which eliminate operational waste and protect compliance.

EXPERIENCE

Prairie Payments Joint Venture — Operations Specialist

SEPTEMBER 2025 - PRESENT

- **Created automated testing reports** which eliminated over two working days per week of updating the executive progress dashboards manually. At the same time, data entry was both simplified and made easier to trace and verify.
- **Created an improved PowerPoint template** which optimized for efficiency and flexibility while rendering presentations identical in look and feel to the original corporate standard. Presentation creation is over twice as fast. The new template was adopted for daily use by multiple teams.
- **Apply UX and Lean methods** to streamline workflows, reduce friction, automate tasks where possible, and support clear, human-centred operations
- **Support peers** across Operations, Business Analysis, and Training (~30 people in total) as a go-to resource for workflow questions and tool adoption
- **Produce formal documentation** and job aids to support tool adoption and process clarity
- **Facilitate knowledge-sharing sessions** and pair informally with colleagues daily to navigate updated processes and templates

Sonar Software — User Experience Designer

JUNE 2022 - JUNE 2025

- **Writing Standards AI tool:** created an AI agent for all of Product & Engineering. This tool tested input — from form labels to long-form text — against the company writing standards, then produced corrected results. The tool was made to be used by Quality Assurance, Development, Product Managers, and UX Design — over 30 people.
- **FCC Label Project:** Created an SVG-based solution for both print and web which addressed regulatory compliance and ease of integration.
 - Initiated and developed a public label generator (available to both clients and non-clients), providing a unique IT service offering that surpassed competitors' static formats and streamlined client service delivery.

SKILLS

Research Proficient at synthesizing general and user-specific qualitative & quantitative data

Responsive web design (HTML/CSS/JS), React, Vue

Web & print layouts (Figma, PenPot, Miro, MilaNote)

Graphics (icons, dynamic SVG creation, photo editing)

Writing (design standards, user stories, user guides)

Analytics

PowerBI, SQL, Excel pivot tables

Agile/rapid context-switching

EDUCATION

Introduction to Journalism

July 2026, University of Toronto

Scrum Master certificate

April 2019

User Experience Design

Certificate December 2018

University of Toronto

Western University

Bachelor of Education,
Intermediate/Senior English and
Computer Science, 1993

Bachelor of Arts, Honours English
Language & Literature, 1992

AWARDS

Multiple peer recognition awards,
2011-2025

Innovation Challenge 2017:
2nd place team member

MENTORSHIP

Mentored team members at work and
ADPlist members globally

- Measured Impact: the solution attracted 210 companies in its first year, with 59% representing new business opportunities (92 marketing qualified leads + 32 new prospects). This validated the strategic decision to create a client-goodwill tool that also functioned as a lead generator, successfully balancing support for existing clients with new business development.
- **Account Overview Customization:** Addressed client complaints and development team feedback by designing a UI update with card filters and rearrangement controls, improving user experience through successful collaboration across multiple teams.
- **New Product Integration:** UI designer on the integration of a new payment processing service (SonarPay) into the main application.
- **Core Feature Update:** Collaborated with development to support multiple data services per account, designing simple-to-use UI controls with safeguards to prevent accidental use by ineligible clients

Symcor, Toronto — User Experience Designer, Senior BSA

DECEMBER 2006 - JUNE 2022

Senior User Experience Designer November 2018 - June 2022

- Used Google Analytics and other tools to conduct web site analysis on public-facing corporate site for SEO improvements, and helped Marketing correct site structural errors
- Accessibility analysis of all 15+ products created internally against WCAG AA standards; consulted on compliance projects
- Evaluated & redesigned electronic statements for PDF/UA compliance
- Researched user needs, conducted comparative analysis, and created customer journey maps, personas, card sort tests, and other UX research artifacts
- Trained/evangelized UX best practices in my department and throughout the company
- Created research-based, responsive, accessible, interactive UI wireframes
- Developed dynamic, responsive design solution which worked in both web and print, using SVG format's internal structure and JavaScript
- Created web and print wireframes in accordance with federal regulations and client specifications
- Architected InDesign files so they could be imported by the development team directly into the print composition software
- Collaborated with external and internal stakeholders to create and document solutions
- Designed and coded internal web sites for committees and teams
- Trained junior designers and created weekly team ceremonies
- Evaluated 8+ off-the-shelf design systems (IBM Carbon, Material Design, Clarity, and more) and evangelized approved option (Carbon)
- Interviewed UX job candidates and recommended successful candidates to management

Senior Business Systems Analyst, December 2006 - November 2018

- On a 24-month Agile project, designed a new documentation method which satisfied the needs of both QA & dev (user stories in JIRA) and upper management (who wanted traditional formal documentation in MS-Word), without creating new work for the BSAs

- Collaborated with external and internal stakeholders to create and document solutions
- Practice lead, training my team on writing standards
- Represented my team on standards committees

StatPro (formerly FRI Corporation), Toronto — Senior BSA

MARCH 2006 - NOVEMBER 2006

- Collaborated with external clients to derive and document business requirements and define functional level design specifications
- Analysed all levels and complexity of system/business issues

Brookfield (Contract), Toronto — Client Trainer, QA lead, BSA

FEBRUARY 2002 -MARCH 2006

Business Systems Analyst/QA Lead, 2004-2006

- Designed UI mock-ups and interactive prototypes
- QA lead on software testing: functional and usability testing, including writing test cases and observing users work with the software
- Used SQL queries to verify software was working correctly
- Managed project scope and schedule for my team and with the external client (a major bank) on a project of 9 months' duration
- Collaborated with external clients to derive and document business requirements and define functional level design specifications

Software application trainer, 2002-2004

- Wrote, implemented, and delivered internal & external training, using both remote and in-person methodologies
- Interviewed internal subject matter experts (real estate law clerks) on best practices to train client law clerks on the company software

Webhelp, Toronto —Program Implementation Specialist/Trainer

JULY 2000 - JANUARY 2002

- Analyzed customer satisfaction reports and user feedback for ways to improve the customer experience, then delivered appropriate training
- Responsible for project management, training teams of 30+ people, and service launches for this on-line customer support centre (chat and email)

Thames Valley District School Board, London ON — Teacher

JUNE 1993 - JUNE 2000

- Taught secondary school credit courses to both adults & teenagers
- Specialized in Web Page Design and Multimedia Design courses
 - Wrote course curriculum to comply with Ministry of Education regulations, including assignments and tests